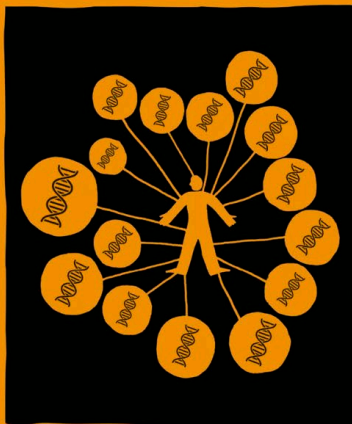




IT IS TO JUSTICE WHAT THE TELESCOPE IS FOR THE STARS

DNA TESTING (1986)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Criminal law

BEFORE

c. 1900 Fingerprinting is adopted as the first scientific way to identify crime suspects.

1953 The structure of DNA, the genetic code governing life, is revealed by scientists James Watson, Francis Crick, Rosalind Franklin, and Maurice Wilkins in the UK.

AFTER

1994 The FBI coordinates DNA profiling across the US.

2002 The INTERPOL DNA database is established; 84 countries participate.

From 2010 Increasingly complex software programs are developed to analyze and identify DNA samples.

2017 The Rapid DNA Act in the US boosts further research into DNA as a policing tool.

Scientists show that **DNA samples** can exactly **identify any individual**.



Law enforcement agencies around the world routinely adopt DNA profiling.



DNA databases provide a rapidly growing resource: millions of records are assembled, and their applications grow.



Concerns remain that DNA testing is not always stringently applied; the **potential for misuse** is clear.

DNA (deoxyribonucleic acid) profiling was the most important breakthrough in forensic crime-solving since the widespread introduction of fingerprinting in the early 20th century. The value of the DNA molecule in forensics relies on the fact that although 99.9 percent of the DNA of every human who has ever lived is identical, the

0.1 percent difference provides irrefutable identification of any individual (apart from identical twins). DNA can be sampled from saliva, skin, blood, hair, or cells. To be of value, however, it is essential that both the sampling and analysis are performed to exacting standards.

The first use of DNA testing in a criminal investigation was to establish innocence rather than